



FIDUNIO

Private Messaging

User Guide

Version 1.1.54a

Repository [willyros01/hermes](#) (project name: Hermes)

Prepared 23 September 2026

About this guide

This guide explains, step by step, how to use FIDUNIO on an iPhone, an iPad or a computer. It was written by reading the app's own screen code at version **1.1.54a**, so every button name, message and limit quoted here is the one the app actually uses.

About the pictures. The phone and tablet pictures in this guide are **illustrations drawn from the screen code**, not screenshots. Layout, wording and order match the code, but colours and spacing will look slightly different on your device. If you send real screenshots, the next edition can place them beside each illustration.

The orange numbered circles on each picture match the numbered notes printed beside it.

Contents

1. Welcome to FIDUNIO
2. Joining with an invitation
3. Adding FIDUNIO to your Home Screen
4. Signing in and unlocking
5. If you forget your password
6. A tour of the main screen
7. Starting a private conversation
8. The chat screen
9. What the message labels mean
10. Photos, videos, audio and files
11. Reactions, replies and deleting messages
12. Disappearing messages
13. Groups
14. Archiving and deleting conversations
15. Notifications
16. Settings
17. Your profile and password
18. For administrators
19. Your Recovery File
20. Troubleshooting
21. Glossary

1. Welcome to FIDUNIO

FIDUNIO is a private, invitation-only messaging app for one-to-one chats and group chats. Its internal project name is **Hermes**, which is why the code lives in the repository called hermes.

FIDUNIO runs in a web browser and can be added to your Home Screen so it opens like a normal app. It works on iPhone, iPad, Android, Fire tablets and desktop browsers.

What makes it private

- **End-to-end encryption.** Your messages, photos and files are locked on your device before they leave it, and only the people in the conversation can unlock them. The server stores only scrambled data.
- **Invitation only.** Nobody can create an account without a single-use invitation from an administrator.
- **One six-digit PIN.** You choose one FIDUNIO PIN. It unlocks the app on your device and protects your encryption keys. Your PIN is never stored.
- **Private notifications.** Notifications say only **FIDUNIO — New message**. They never contain the message text.

What you need

- An invitation link from a FIDUNIO administrator.
- An email address and a password.
- A six-digit PIN you will remember.
- An internet connection. FIDUNIO also keeps working offline and sends your messages when the connection returns.

Tip for easier reading: FIDUNIO has three text sizes — **A**, **A+** and **A++**. Go to **Settings → General → Text Size** and choose **A++** for extra-large text everywhere in the app (see chapter 16).

2. Joining with an invitation

An administrator sends you an invitation by email, text message or another app. It contains a **Join FIDUNIO** link, the role you have been given (User or Admin), the expiry date and a link to the Quick Start Guide.

Your invitation is **personal and single-use**. The first person to use it consumes it, so do not forward it. If it has expired or was already used, ask for a new one.

The screenshot shows the FIDUNIO app interface for joining via an invitation. At the top, the time is 9:41. The FIDUNIO logo (a profile of a person with wings) and the text 'FIDUNIO Private Messaging' are at the top. Below this are two buttons: 'Sign In' and 'Join FIDUNIO'. The 'Join FIDUNIO' button is highlighted with a red circle and the number 1. Below the buttons are several input fields: 'Invitation code' (containing 'k7F2...9QxA'), 'Display name' (containing 'Your display name'), 'Email' (containing 'name@example.com'), and 'Password' (containing 'At least 6 characters'). Each of these fields is highlighted with a red circle and a number (2, 3, 4, and 5 respectively). Below the password field is a section titled 'Choose a six-digit PIN' with six empty boxes for digits. The bottom of the screen features a large 'Join FIDUNIO' button, which is also highlighted with a red circle and the number 5. At the very bottom, the text 'FIDUNIO 1.1.54a • Invite-only access' is displayed.

- 1 The **Join FIDUNIO** tab is selected automatically when you open an invitation link. Use **Sign In** if you already have an account.
- 2 **Invitation code** — filled in for you from the link. You can also paste a code here.
- 3 Enter your **Display name** (how others see you), your **Email** and a **Password** of at least 6 characters.
- 4 **Choose a six-digit PIN**. Tap the first box and type six digits. This is your FIDUNIO PIN — remember it.
- 5 Tap **Join FIDUNIO**. The button shows **Creating account...** while FIDUNIO sets up your account and encryption.

Figure 2.1 — The Join FIDUNIO screen

Step by step

1. Tap the **Join FIDUNIO** link in your invitation.
2. Check that the invitation code is filled in.

3. Type your display name, email address and password.
4. Choose your six-digit FIDUNIO PIN.
5. Tap **Join FIDUNIO**. When it finishes, the Messages screen opens.

If something is wrong, a red note appears under the button — for example, if the PIN is not exactly six digits, or the invitation has expired or was already used.

3. Adding FIDUNIO to your Home Screen

Installing is optional and separate from joining. It gives FIDUNIO its own icon and, on iPhone and iPad, it is what allows notifications to work reliably.

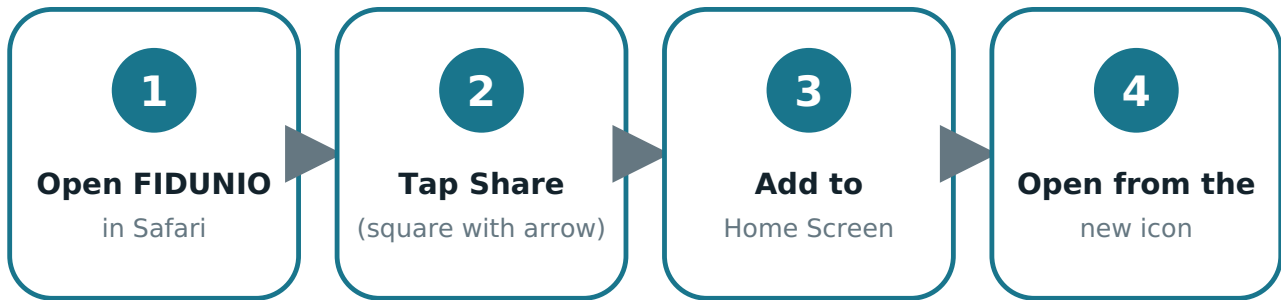


Figure 3.1 — Adding FIDUNIO to the Home Screen on iPhone or iPad

iPhone and iPad

1. Open FIDUNIO in **Safari**.
2. Tap the **Share** button (the square with an arrow pointing up).
3. Scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**.
4. From now on, open FIDUNIO from its new Home Screen icon.

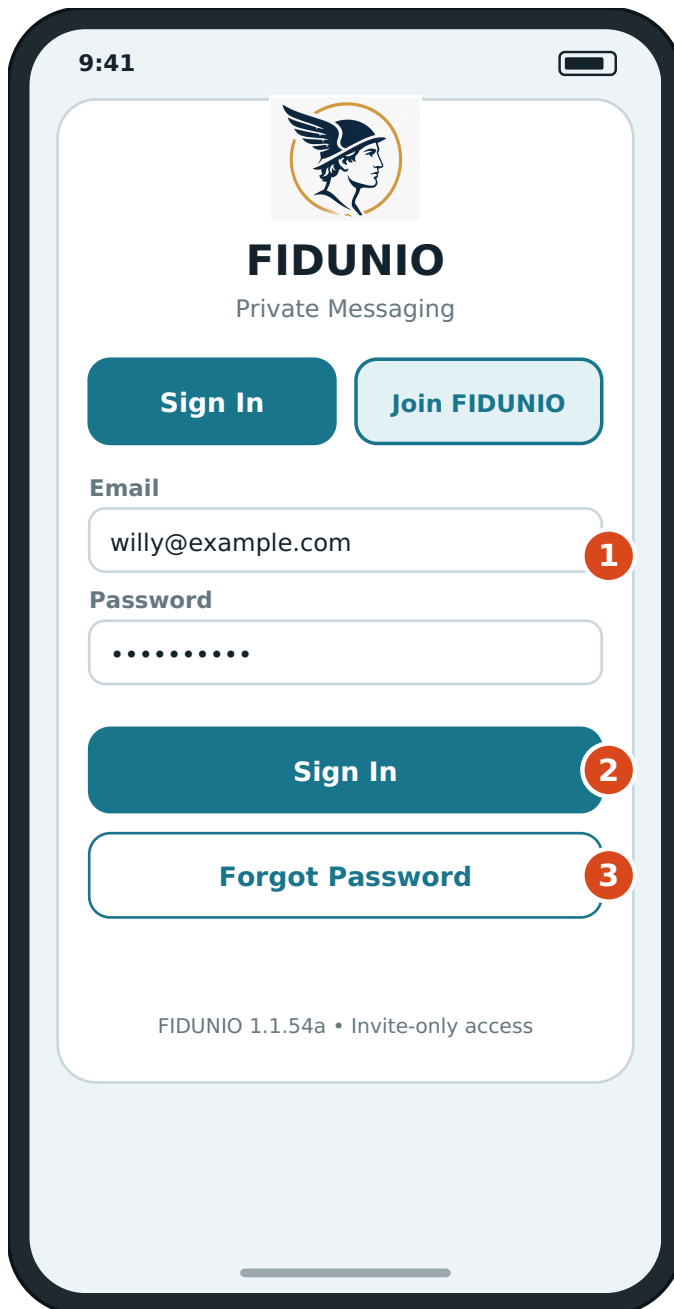
Android, Fire tablets and computers

Open the browser menu and choose **Add to Home screen**, **Install app** or **Create shortcut**, whichever your browser offers. The same instructions are shown inside the app under **Settings** → **Install**.

Do not clear the browser's website data for FIDUNIO on a device that is working. That erases this installation's saved messages and keys. If it happens, you can recover with your PIN (chapter 4) or your Recovery File (chapter 19).

4. Signing in and unlocking

There are two different "doors" in FIDUNIO. **Signing in** uses your email and password and is needed only on a new device or after you sign out. **Unlocking** uses your six-digit PIN (or Face ID / Touch ID) and happens every time you come back to the app.



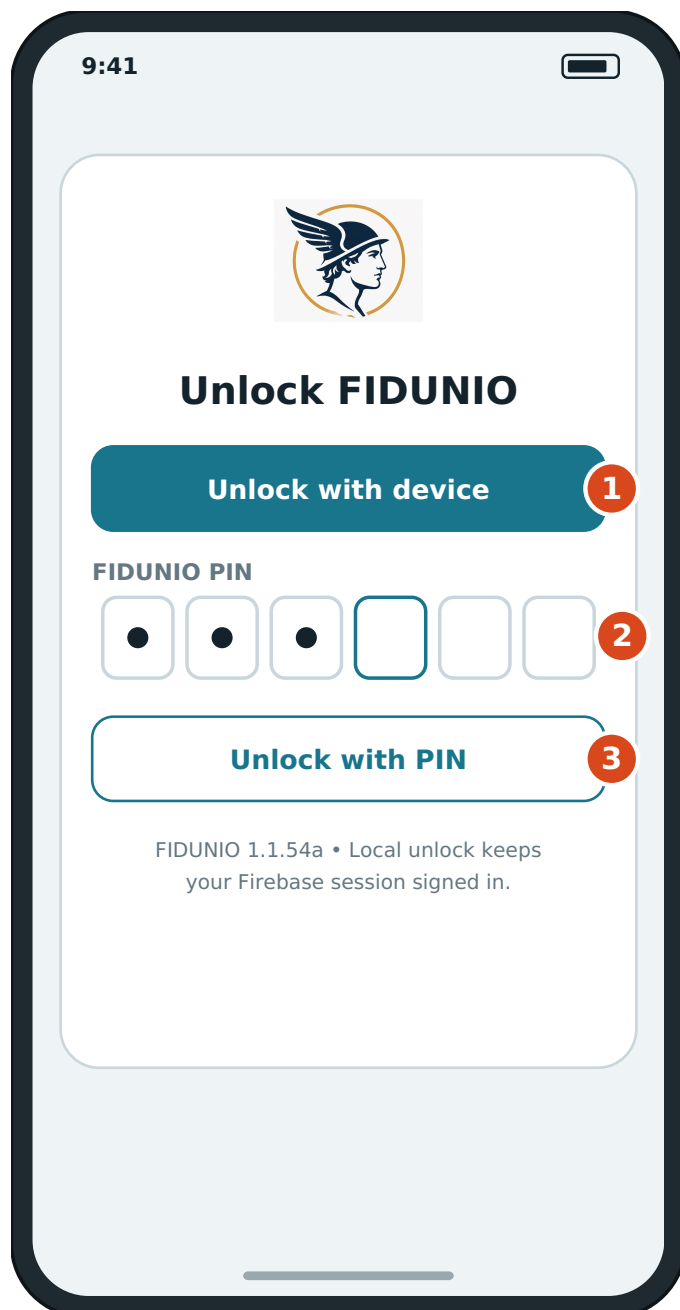
- 1 Type your **Email** and **Password**.
- 2 Tap **Sign In**. It shows **Signing in...** while it works.
- 3 **Forgot Password** — see chapter 5. Type your email first, then tap it.

Figure 4.1 — The Sign In screen

After signing in on a new device

If this device has never held your secure messaging keys, FIDUNIO asks you to **Restore Messaging**: enter your password (if asked) and your **existing** six-digit PIN. Your old conversations and the same encryption identity come back — nothing is reset. On a first-ever setup the button reads **Continue** instead.

Use Another Account signs out and returns to the Sign In screen.



- 1 Unlock with device** — appears only if you turned on Face ID / Touch ID / device unlock in Settings.
- 2 FIDUNIO PIN** — type your six digits. FIDUNIO checks automatically when the sixth digit is entered.
- 3 Unlock with PIN** — tap this if the check did not start by itself.

Figure 4.2 — The Unlock FIDUNIO screen

When does FIDUNIO lock?

FIDUNIO locks after the period of inactivity you choose in **Settings → General → Privacy & Access → Lock after inactivity**, and you can lock it at once with **Lock Now**. Unlocking with the PIN does not sign you out of your account.

Messages you may see

Message	What it means and what to do
Incorrect PIN.	The six digits were wrong. Try again.
PIN check did not finish. Please try again.	The device was slow to answer (FIDUNIO waits up to 12 seconds). Your PIN was not rejected — simply try again.
Device unlock was cancelled or unavailable. Use your PIN instead.	Face ID / Touch ID did not complete. Type your PIN.

FIDUNIO remains locked

The device could not read the stored PIN check. Your PIN has **not** been reset. Close FIDUNIO completely and open it again.

5. If you forget your password

Your password and your PIN work together: the password signs you in, and the PIN proves you own your encryption keys. If you forget your **password**, you can reset it and keep all your messages — as long as you still know your **PIN**.

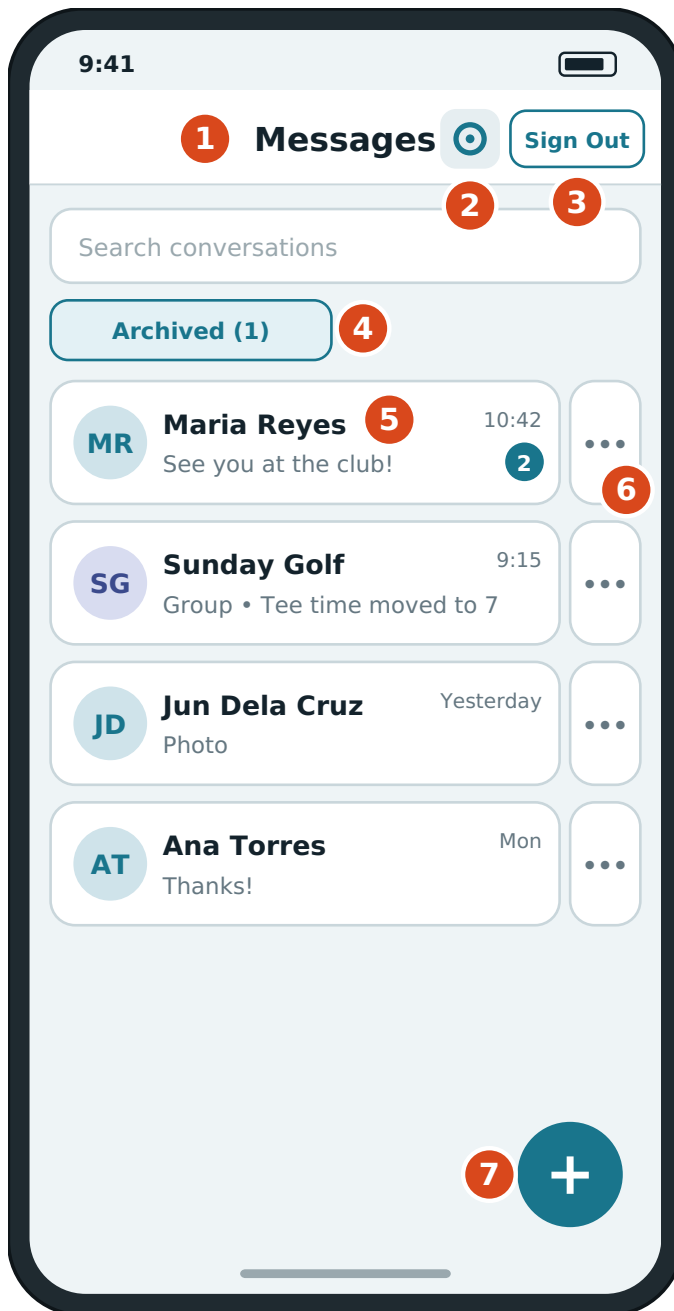
1. On the Sign In screen, type your email address.
2. Tap **Forgot Password**. The note says **Password reset email sent**.
3. Open the email and choose a new password.
4. Come back to FIDUNIO and **Sign In** with the new password.
5. FIDUNIO shows **Recover Secure Messaging**. Enter your **existing six-digit FIDUNIO PIN** and tap **Recover Messaging**.
6. Your same messaging identity is restored and FIDUNIO opens normally.

Recovery needs three things together: your signed-in account, your exact six-digit PIN, and FIDUNIO's recovery service. Nobody — not even an administrator — can read your messages with only a password reset.

If you cannot reset the password yourself, an administrator can send you a one-time **account recovery** link that is valid for 30 minutes (chapter 18). You still use your own password and PIN; the administrator never sees them.

6. A tour of the main screen

On iPhone (and other phones)



- 1 **Messages** — the title of the main screen.
- 2 **Settings** (the gear icon).
- 3 **Sign Out** — signs this device out of your account.
- 4 **Archived (n)** — shows conversations you archived. Tap again (**Back to Messages**) to return.
- 5 A conversation row: initials, name, the latest message preview and the time. Group rows start with **Group •**. A teal badge counts unread messages.
- 6 ... — Conversation actions: Archive, or Delete for Everyone (chapter 14).
- 7 + — start a new conversation or group.

Figure 6.1 — The Messages screen on iPhone

Use the **Search conversations** box at the top to find a chat by name or by words in the latest message.

On iPad and wide screens

On screens at least 700 points wide, FIDUNIO shows two panes side by side: the conversation list on the left and the open chat on the right.

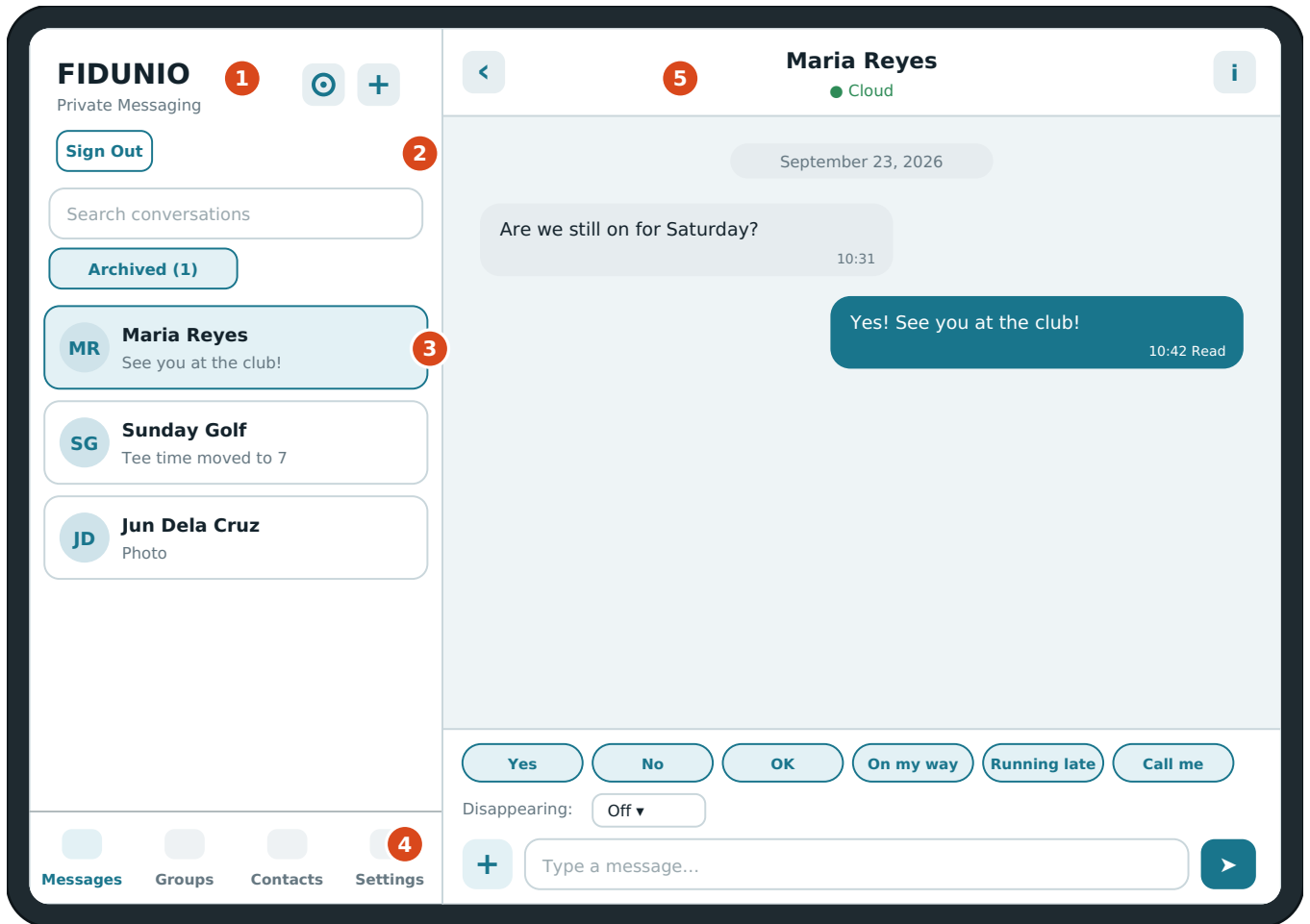
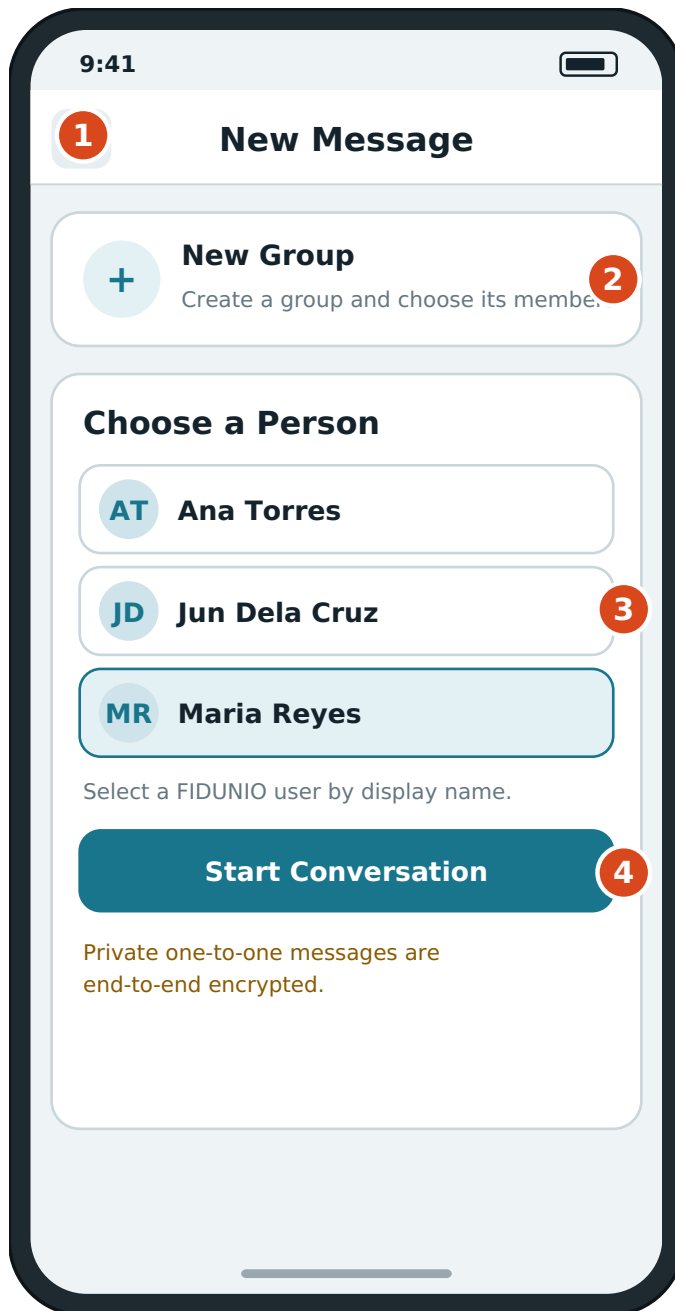


Figure 6.2 — The two-pane iPad layout

- 1 Brand area with **Settings** and **New conversation (+)**. 2 **Sign Out**, search and **Archived**. 3 The selected conversation is highlighted. 4 Bottom bar: **Messages**, **Groups**, **Contacts** (starts a new message) and **Settings**. 5 The open chat.

7. Starting a private conversation



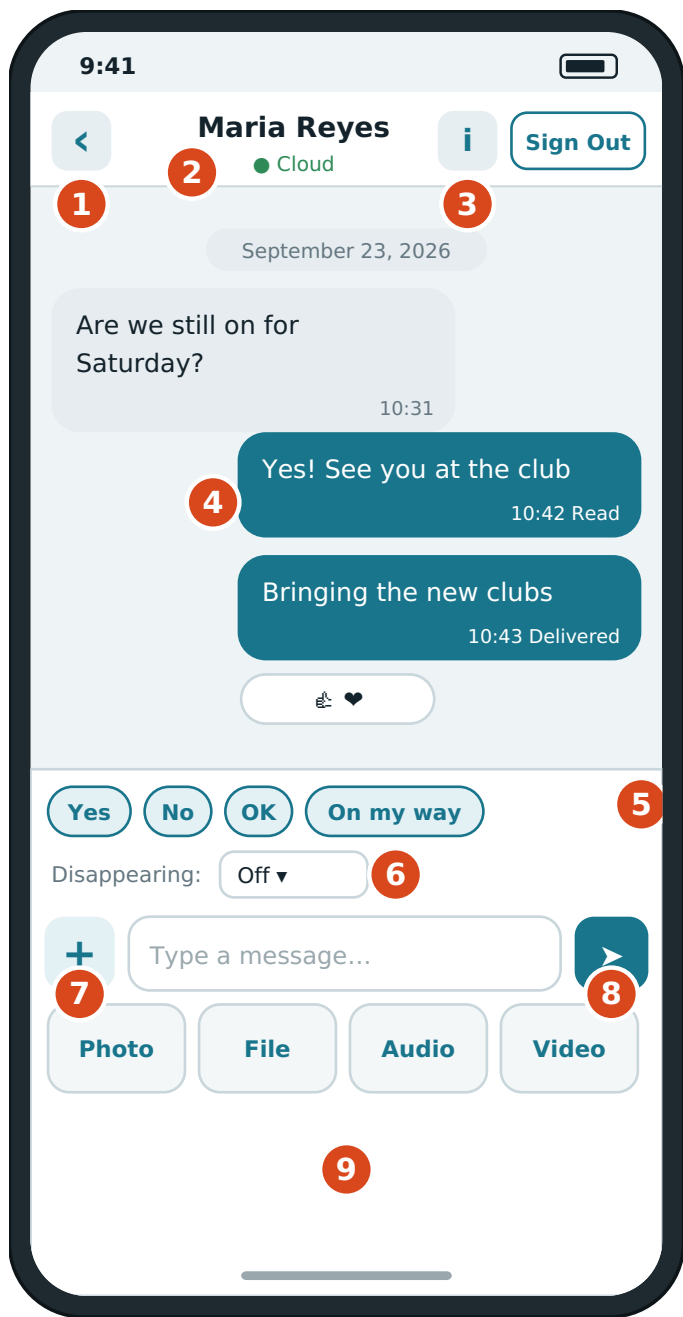
- 1 **Back** returns to Messages.
- 2 **New Group** — create a group instead (chapter 13).
- 3 **Choose a Person** — tap a FIDUNIO user by their display name.
- 4 **Start Conversation**. It shows **Connecting...**, then the chat opens.

Figure 7.1 — The New Message screen

1. Tap + on the Messages screen (or **Contacts** on iPad).
2. Tap the person you want to talk to.
3. Tap **Start Conversation**.

The note **Private one-to-one messages are end-to-end encrypted** is a reminder that only the two of you can read the chat. If you already have a chat with that person, FIDUNIO opens the existing one.

8. The chat screen



- 1 **Back** to the conversation list.
- 2 The other person's name. Under it, ● **Cloud** for a one-to-one chat, or the member count and **Secure** for a group.
- 3 **Info (i)** — Chat Info for a one-to-one chat, Group Info for a group.
- 4 Your messages are on the right in teal with a status label; theirs are on the left in grey. A date line separates each day.
- 5 **Quick replies** — Yes, No, OK, On my way, Running late, Call me. Tapping one puts it in the typing box.
- 6 **Disappearing** — choose a timer for the next messages you send (chapter 12).
- 7 + opens the tools row.
- 8 **Send**. On a keyboard, Enter sends and Shift+Enter makes a new line.
- 9 Tools: **Photo, File, Audio, Video** (chapter 10).

Figure 8.1 — A one-to-one chat

Reactions appear as small chips under a bubble (for example 👍 ❤️). Anything you have typed but not sent is kept for that conversation while you move around the app.

Banners at the top of a chat

Banner	Meaning
Offline — messages will be queued and sent automatically when connection returns.	You have no connection. Keep typing; FIDUNIO sends later.
Loading new message...	You opened a notification and FIDUNIO is fetching that exact message.
Firebase connection problem: ...	The server could not be reached or refused a

	request. See Troubleshooting.
New members see conversation only from their join time...	Shown in groups as a privacy reminder.

9. What the message labels mean

Each message you send shows a small label in the corner of its bubble. It moves down this ladder as the message travels:

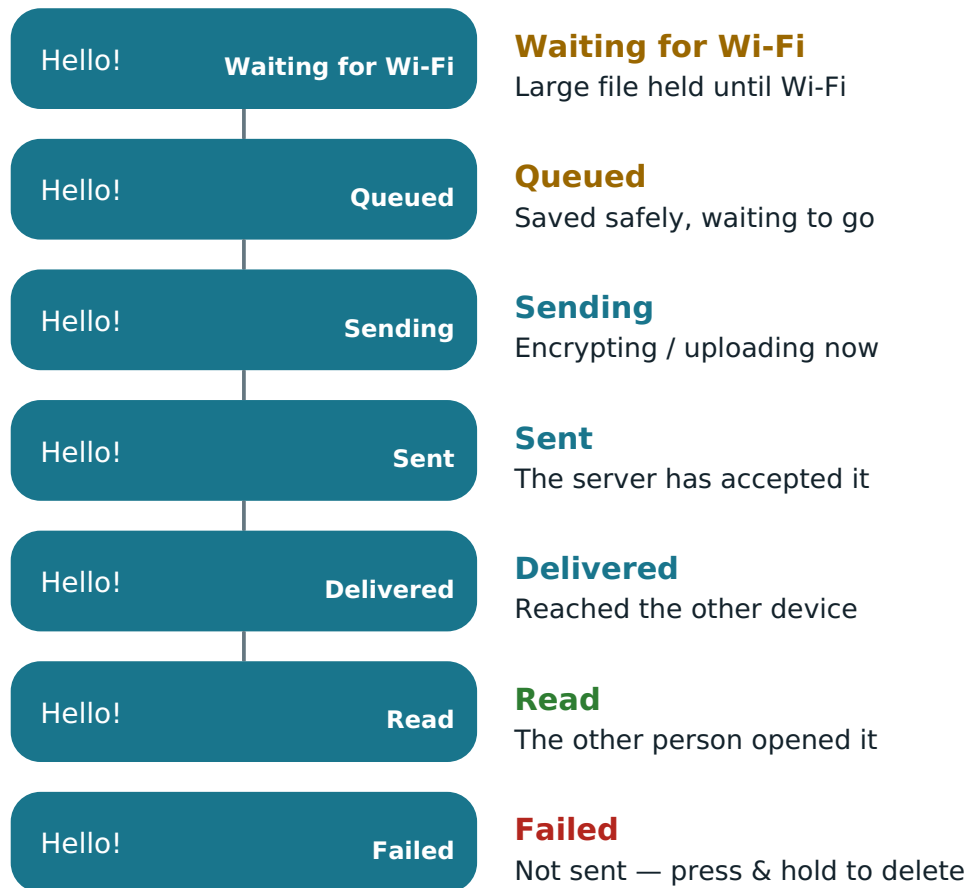
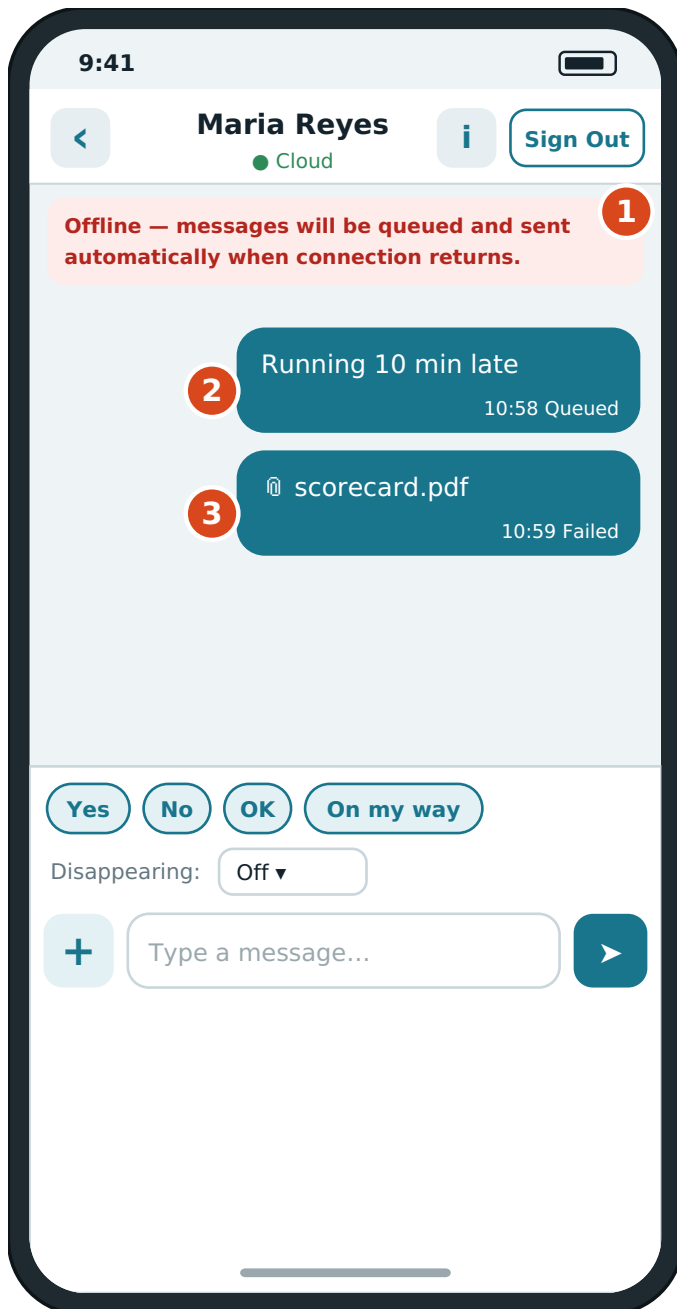


Figure 9.1 — The life of a sent message

Queued and **Waiting for Wi-Fi** messages are stored safely and encrypted on your device. FIDUNIO retries automatically when the connection returns — you do not need to press anything.

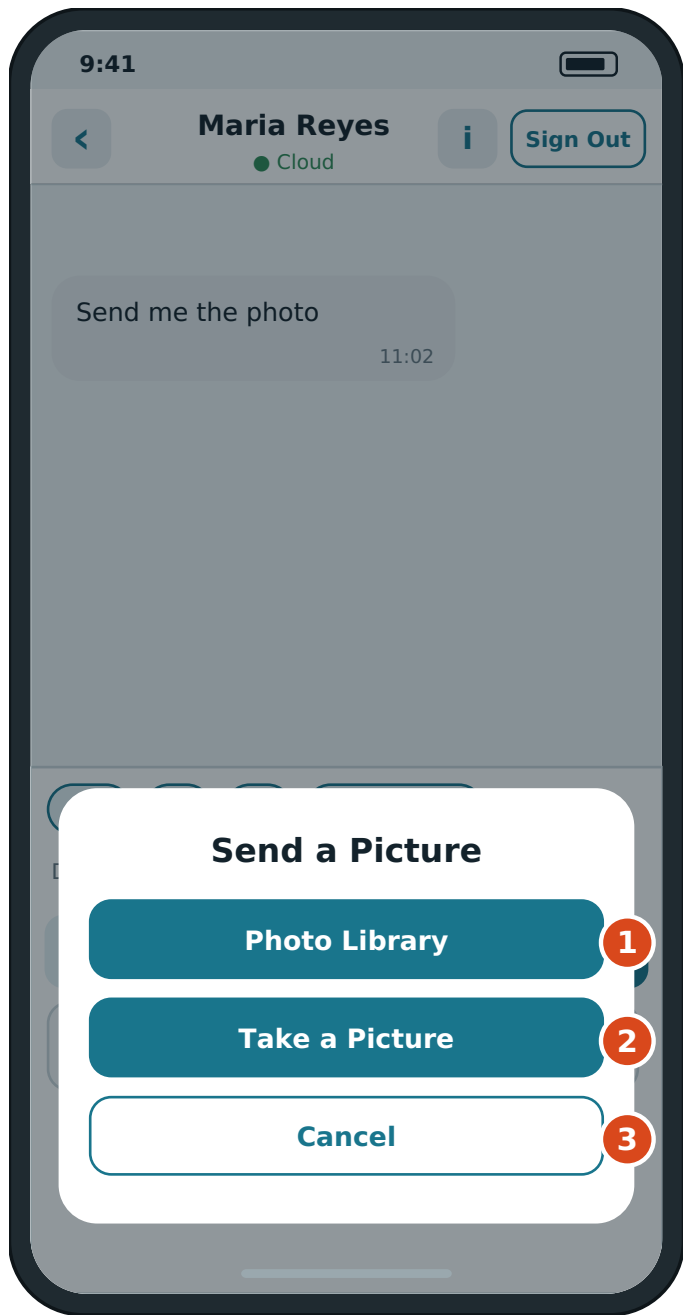


- 1 The red offline banner.
- 2 **Queued** — will be sent automatically.
- 3 **Failed** — press and hold the message, choose **Delete Message**, then send it again.

Figure 9.2 — Offline with a queued and a failed message

10. Photos, videos, audio and files

Tap + next to the typing box to open the tools row, then choose a tool. Every attachment is encrypted on your phone before it is uploaded.



- 1 **Photo Library** — pick an existing picture.
- 2 **Take a Picture** — opens the camera.
- 3 **Cancel** closes the choice.

Figure 10.1 — Choosing where a picture comes from

Tool	Choices	Largest size
Photo	Photo Library, Take a Picture	12 MB
Video	Photo Library, Camera	50 MB
Audio	Record Audio, Choose Audio File	25 MB
File	Opens the file picker straight away	20 MB

Recording a voice message

1. Tap **+**, then **Audio**, then **Record Audio**.
2. Tap **Start Recording** and allow microphone access if asked.
3. Tap **Stop & Send** when finished, or **Cancel** to throw it away.

Large files and mobile data

Files of 5 MB or more count as **large**. If **Settings → Data → Large attachments on Wi-Fi only** is on, a large file waits with the label **Waiting for Wi-Fi** while you are on mobile data or offline. iPhone and iPad often do not tell the app whether you are on Wi-Fi, so FIDUNIO then asks you directly and sends only if you choose **Send Anyway**.

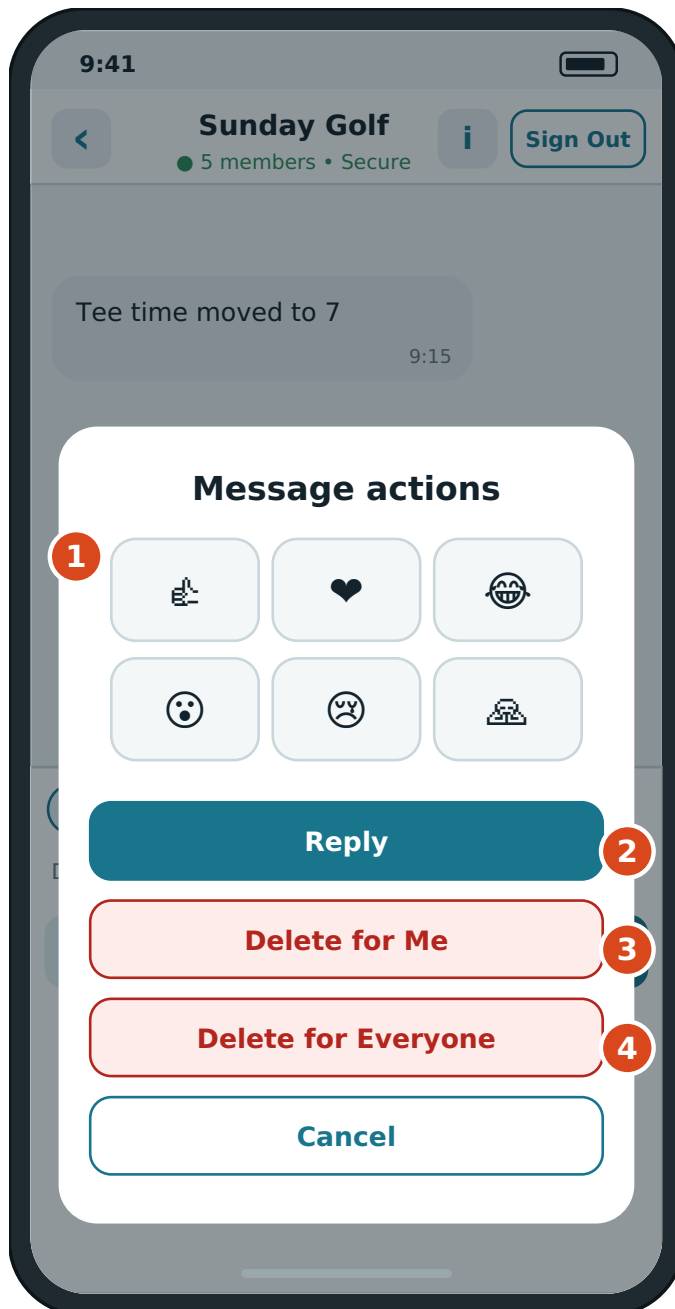
Opening attachments

Photos appear inside the bubble — tap to open full size. Other files show a 📎 name you can tap to download. If one says **could not be opened**, tap **Try Again**.

While you are replying to a group message, attachments are paused — send or cancel the reply first.

11. Reactions, replies and deleting messages

Press and hold any message for about two-thirds of a second to open **Message actions**. (With a keyboard, select the message and press Enter or Space.)



1 Reactions — 👍 ❤️ 😄 😮 😞 🙄. Tap one to react. Tap the same one again to remove it; tap a different one to change it. You have one reaction per message.

2 Reply — groups only. Quotes the message above your answer.

3 Delete for Me — removes the message from this device only.

4 Delete for Everyone — shown only on messages **you** sent. Removes it, and any attachment, for everyone.

Figure 11.1 — Message actions

Deleting a message that has not gone yet

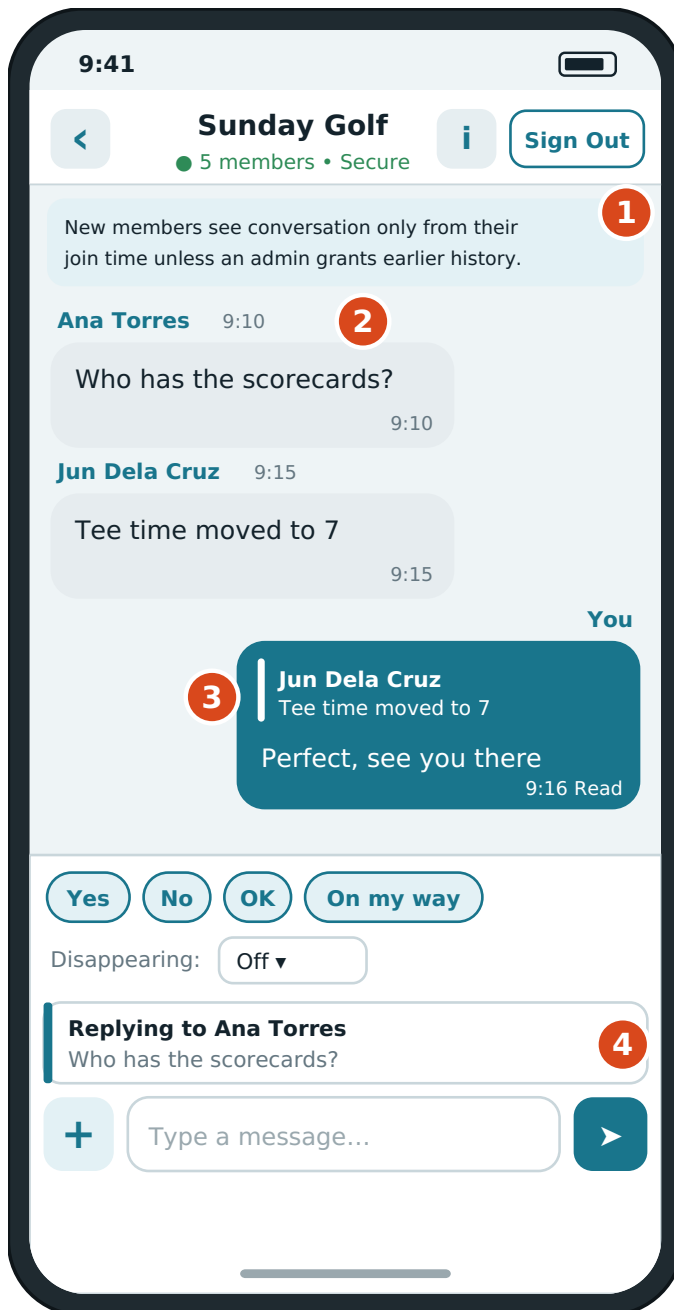
For your own messages that are still **Queued**, **Sending** or **Failed**, the sheet offers **Delete Message**. This cancels the send and removes it from your device.

Replying in a group

1. Press and hold the group message and tap **Reply**.
2. A **Replying to ...** card with a short preview appears above the typing box. Tap **x** to cancel.

3. Type your answer and send. Everyone sees the quoted message above it.

Replies are not offered on disappearing messages, so a permanent reply can never keep a copy of something meant to disappear.



- 1 The group privacy reminder.
- 2 Every group message shows the sender's name and time above the bubble.
- 3 A sent reply shows the quoted sender and preview inside the bubble.
- 4 The **Replying to** card while you write.

Figure 11.2 — Replies and sender names in a group

12. Disappearing messages

Disappearing messages delete themselves after the time you choose. Use the **Disappearing** menu just above the typing box.

Choice	Message disappears
Off	Never (normal message)
5 minutes	5 minutes after it is read
1 hour	1 hour after it is read
1 day	1 day after it is read
7 days	7 days after it is read

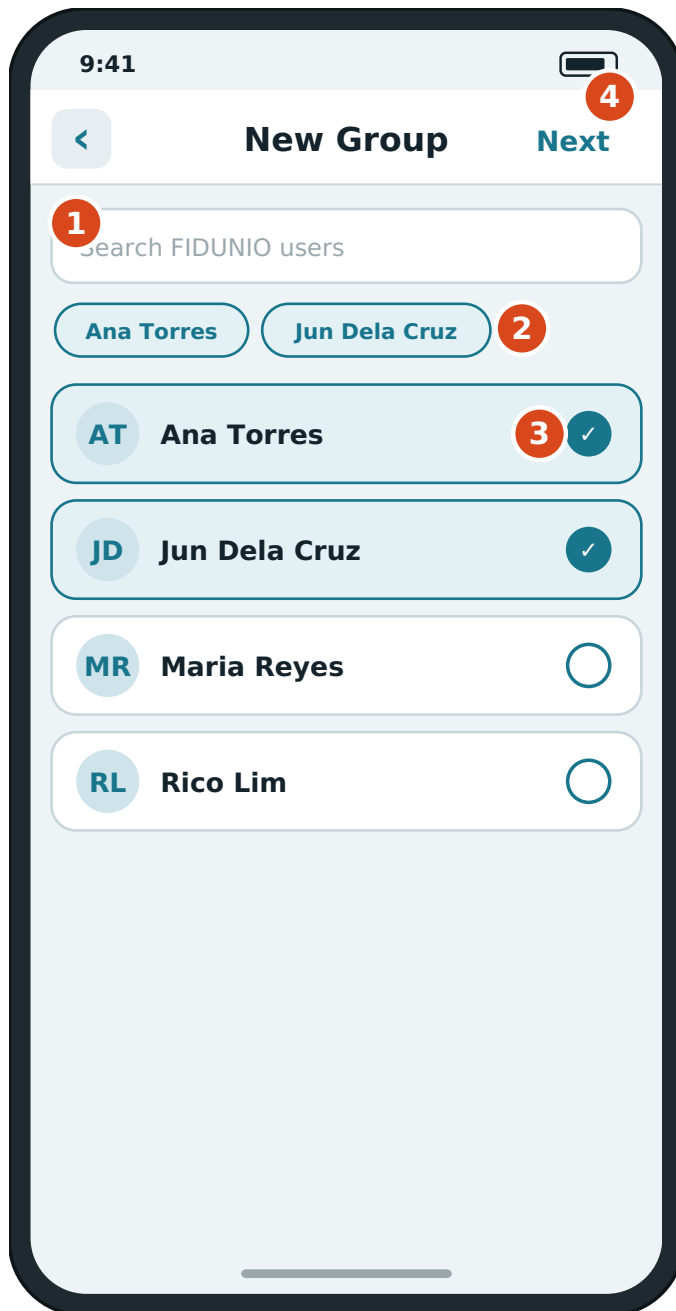
How it works

- The timer starts when the other person **first reads** the message. In a group, each member has their own timer.
- The choice applies to messages you send **from now on**. Changing it later never changes messages already sent.
- When the time is up, FIDUNIO's server deletes the message, its receipts and any attachment completely — there is no "message deleted" placeholder. It checks about once a minute.
- Devices that were offline remove their copy when they reconnect, and they cannot bring an expired message back.

Anyone can still photograph their screen. Disappearing messages protect against stored copies, not against a camera.

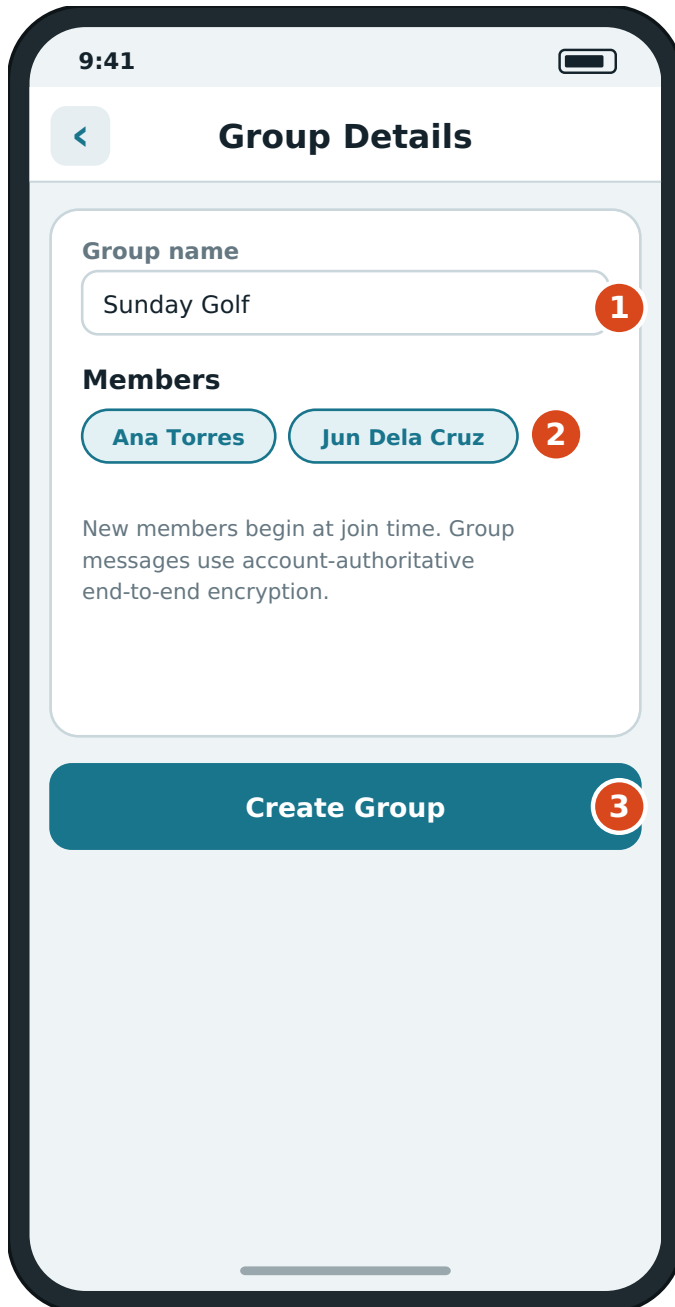
13. Groups

Creating a group



- 1 **Search FIDUNIO users** by name.
- 2 Chosen people appear as chips.
- 3 Tap a person to select or unselect them (a tick shows).
- 4 **Next** — works once at least **2 people** are selected.

Figure 13.1 — Choosing group members



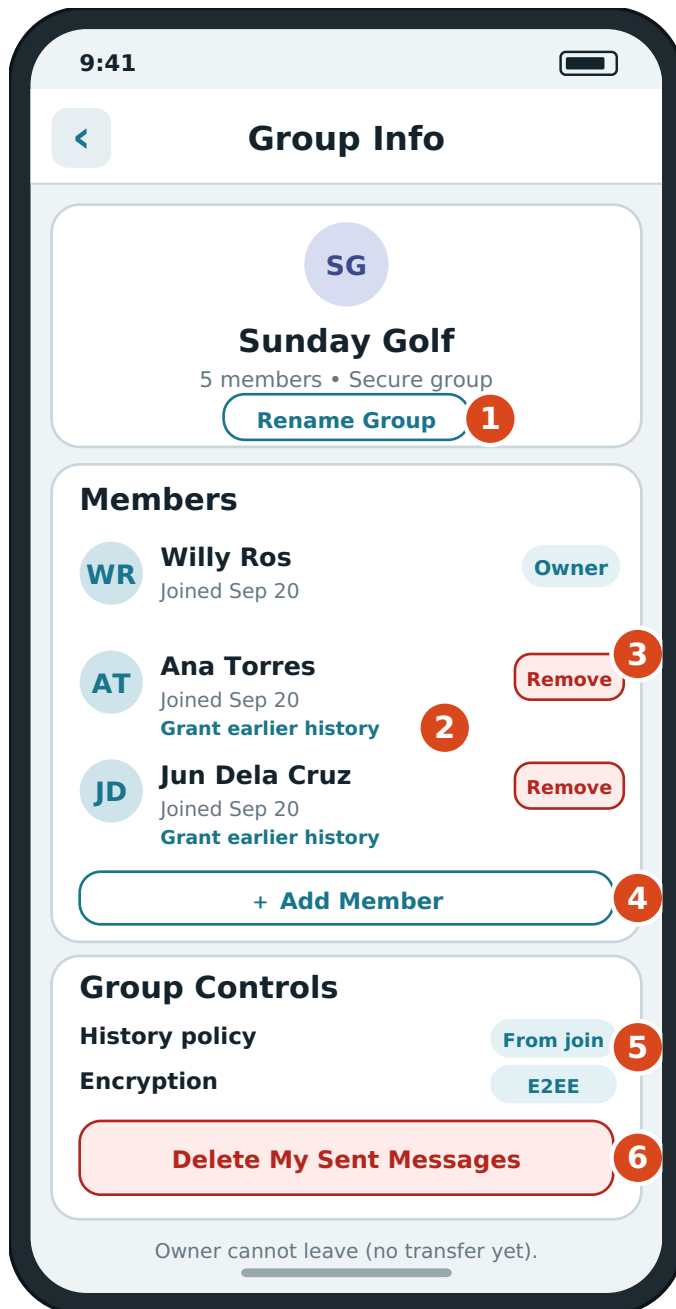
- 1 Type a **Group name** (up to 120 characters).
- 2 The members you chose.
- 3 **Create Group** — the new group chat opens.

Figure 13.2 — Naming the group

Start from **+** → **New Group**, or on the **Groups** screen tap **New Group**. You become the group's **Owner**.

Group Info

Open a group chat and tap **i**.



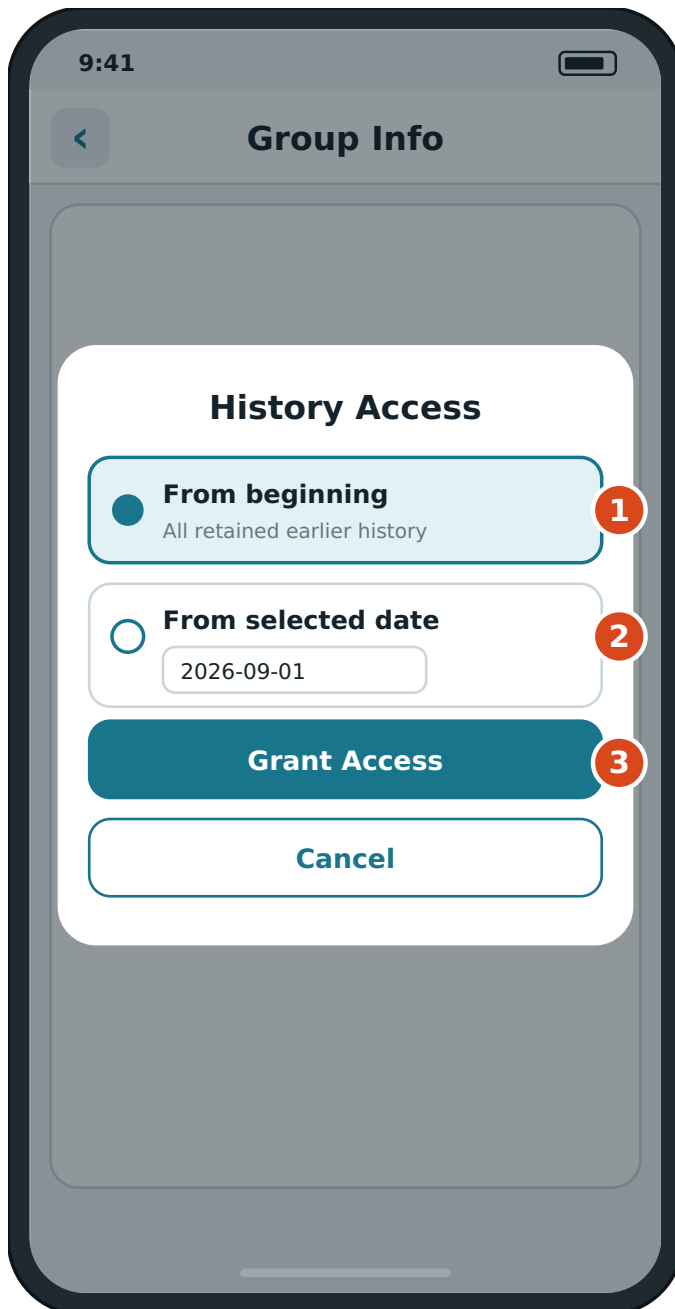
- 1 **Rename Group** (administrators).
- 2 **Grant earlier history** — let a member see messages from before they joined.
- 3 **Remove** a member (administrators; the owner cannot be removed).
- 4 **+ Add Member** (administrators).
- 5 History policy **From join** and **E2EE** encryption.
- 6 **Delete My Sent Messages** in this group (chapter 14).

Figure 13.3 — Group Info

Who sees what

A new member sees messages only **from the moment they join**. Each time someone is added, removed or leaves, FIDUNIO changes the group's secret key, so a person who has left cannot read anything sent afterwards.

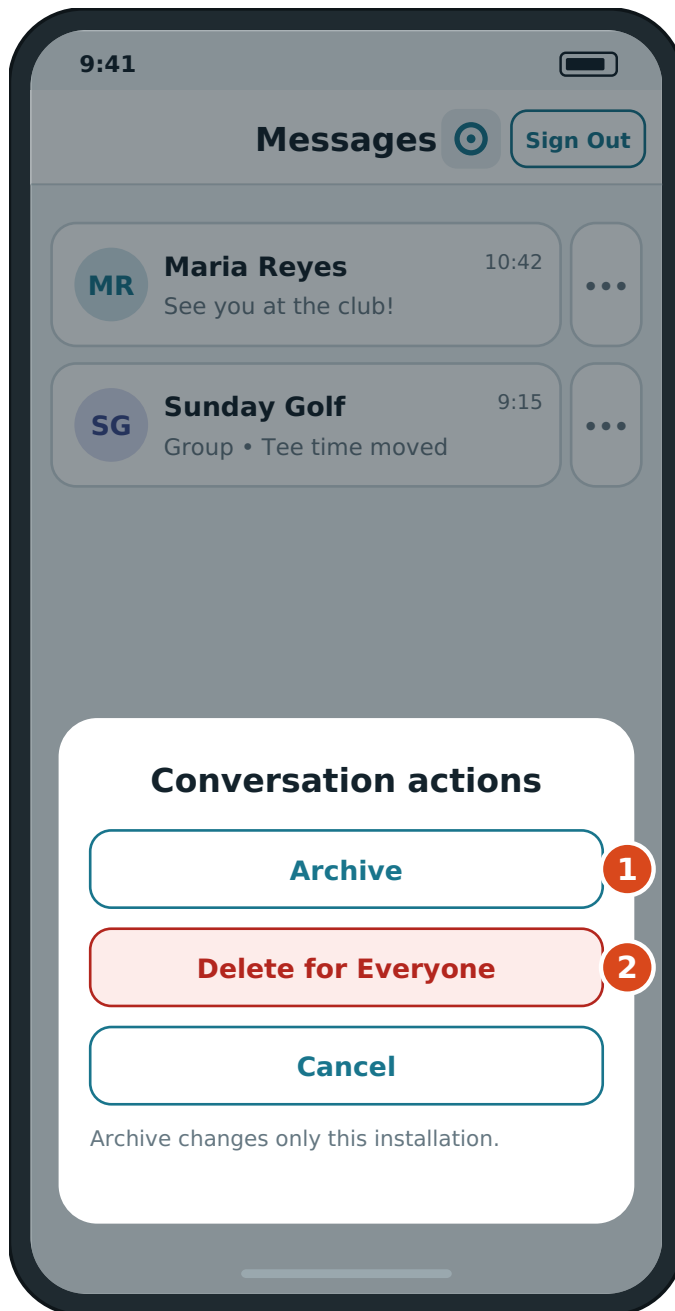
Leave Group is at the bottom of Group Info for ordinary members. The owner cannot leave (ownership transfer is not built yet).



- 1 From beginning** — every earlier message still kept.
- 2 From selected date** — pick the first day to share.
- 3 Grant Access.** FIDUNIO re-encrypts each earlier message individually for that one member.

Figure 13.4 — Granting earlier history

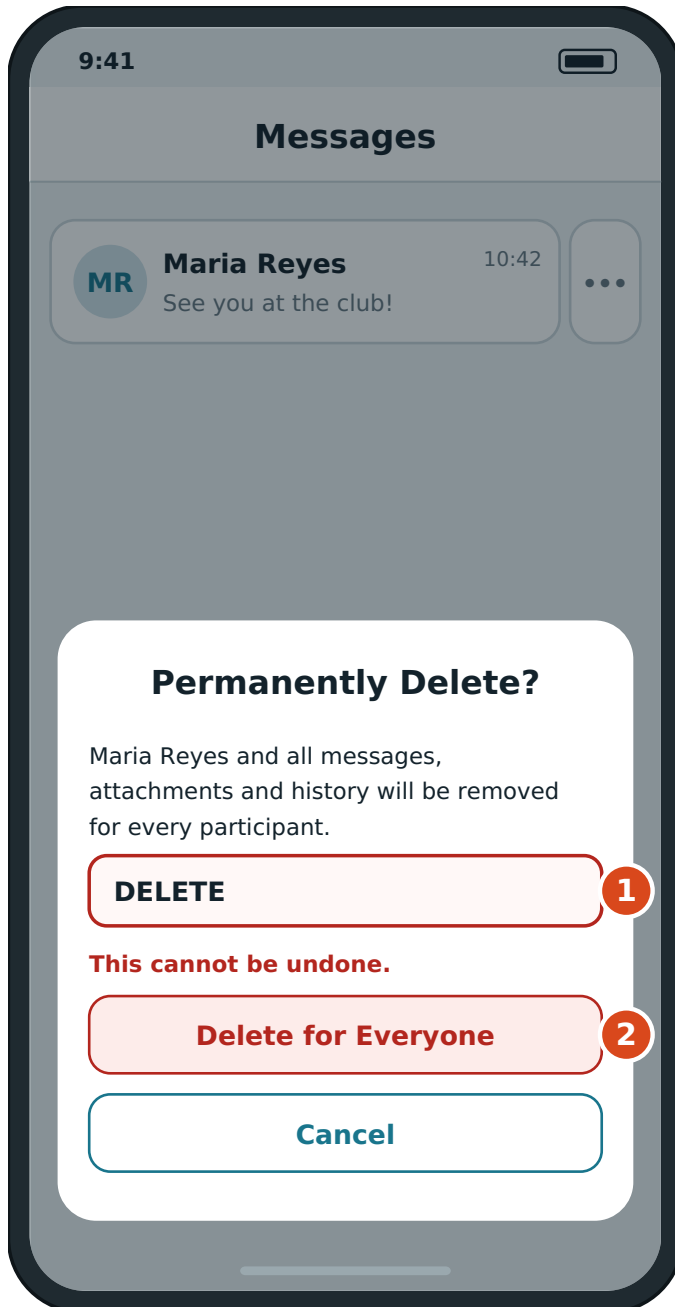
14. Archiving and deleting conversations



1 Archive hides the conversation from the Messages list **on this device only**. Nothing is deleted. New messages keep arriving inside it. Use **Archived** → ... → **Unarchive** to bring it back.

2 Delete for Everyone permanently removes the conversation for all participants. In a one-to-one chat either person may do this; in a group only the **owner** can.

Figure 14.1 — Conversation actions (tap ... on a row)



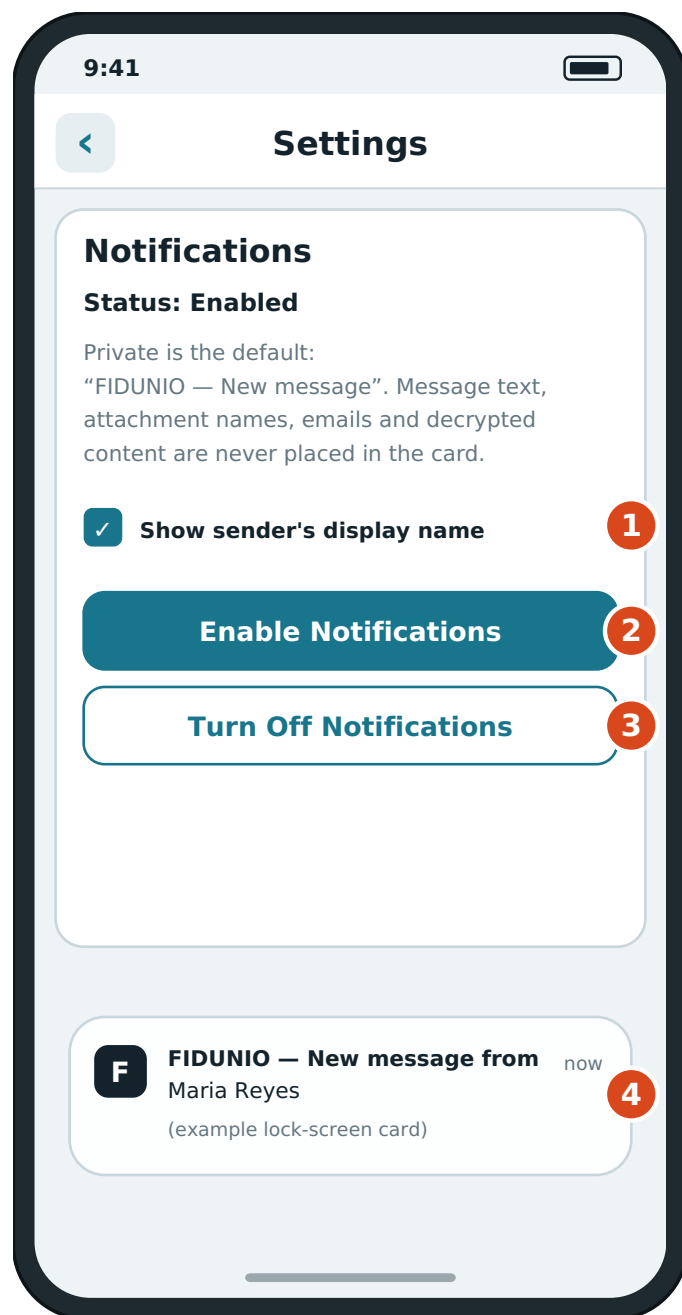
- 1 Type the word **DELETE** in capitals.
- 2 Only then does **Delete for Everyone** become active. This cannot be undone.

Figure 14.2 — Confirming permanent deletion

Delete My Sent Messages

In **Chat Info** (one-to-one) or **Group Info** (groups) the red **Delete My Sent Messages** button removes **every message you have sent** in that conversation, for everyone, including attachments. Messages from other people are kept. You confirm once more and a progress note is shown while it works. It cannot be undone.

15. Notifications



- 1 Show sender's display name** — optional, per device. Off means the card only says New message.
- 2 Enable Notifications** — tap, then allow when the device asks.
- 3 Turn Off Notifications** for this device.
- 4** What a notification looks like. It never contains the message text.

Figure 15.1 — Settings → Notifications

1. On iPhone or iPad, first add FIDUNIO to the Home Screen (chapter 3) and open it from there.
2. Go to **Settings → Notifications** and tap **Enable Notifications**.
3. Allow notifications when asked.

Opening a notification

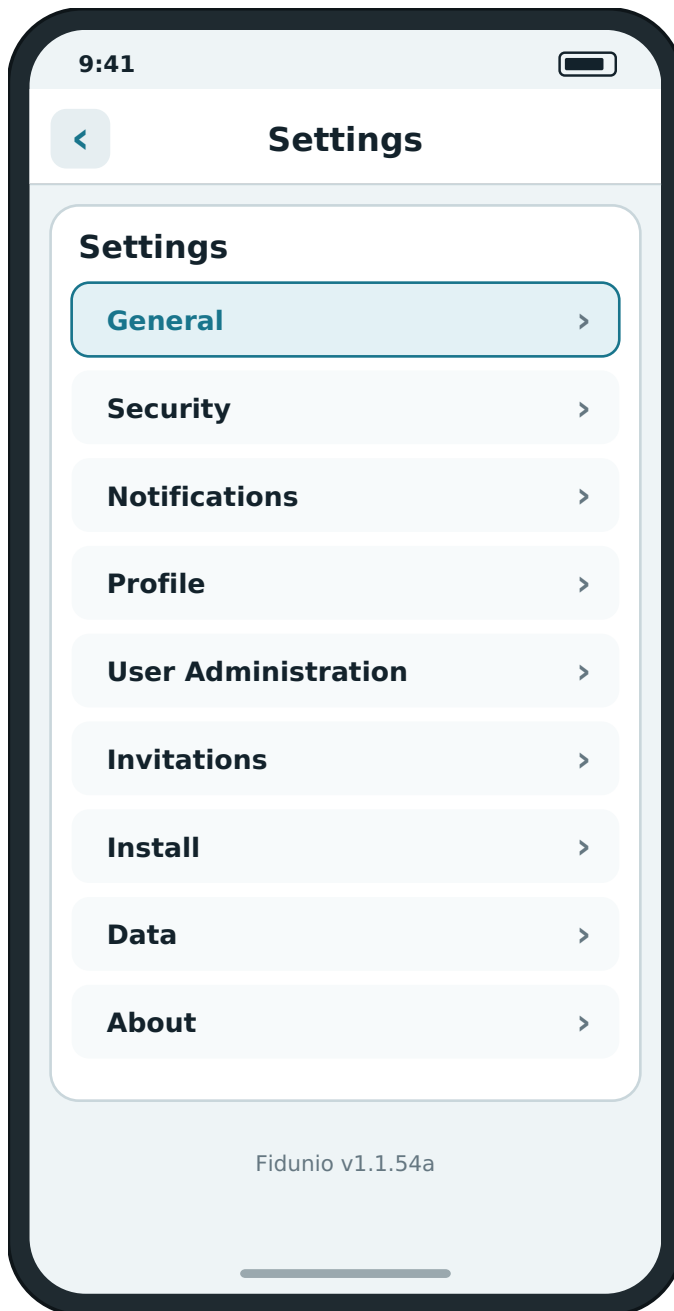
Tap the notification, unlock with your PIN, and FIDUNIO opens the exact conversation at the new message. If several conversations have new messages, a **New messages** list lets you pick one, or tap **Not now**.

Status words

Status	Meaning
Enabled	Working on this device.
Off	Not turned on here.
Permission denied	You refused permission — change it in the device's Settings app.
Unsupported on this device/browser	This browser cannot receive web notifications.
Web Push setup required	The administrator has not finished server setup.

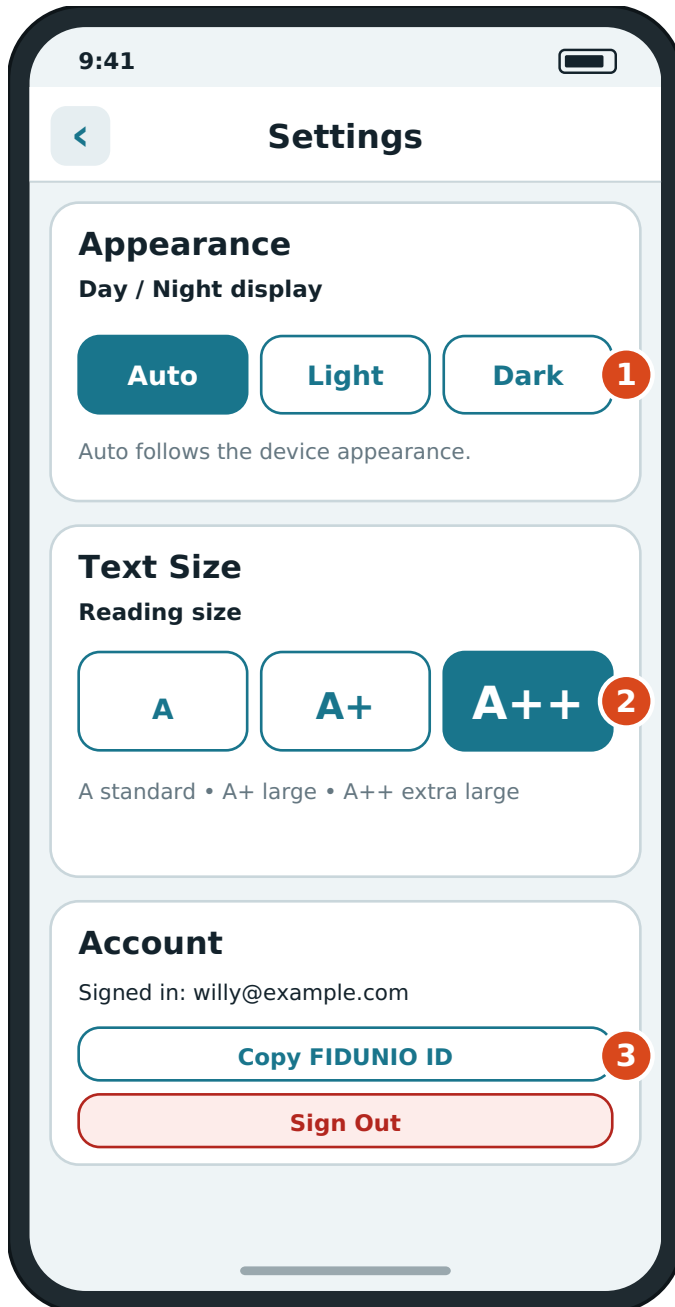
16. Settings

Open Settings with the gear icon. A list of sections appears; tap one to jump to it. The Settings sections are:



- 1 **General** — appearance, text size, account information, and the **Privacy & Access** card (PIN, auto-lock, device unlock).
- 2 **Security** — the FIDUNIO Security (encryption) status.
- 3 **Notifications**, then **Profile** — your name, email, phone, picture and password (chapter 17).
- 4 **User Administration, Invitations, Install, Data** and **About** (version number).

Figure 16.1 — Settings sections

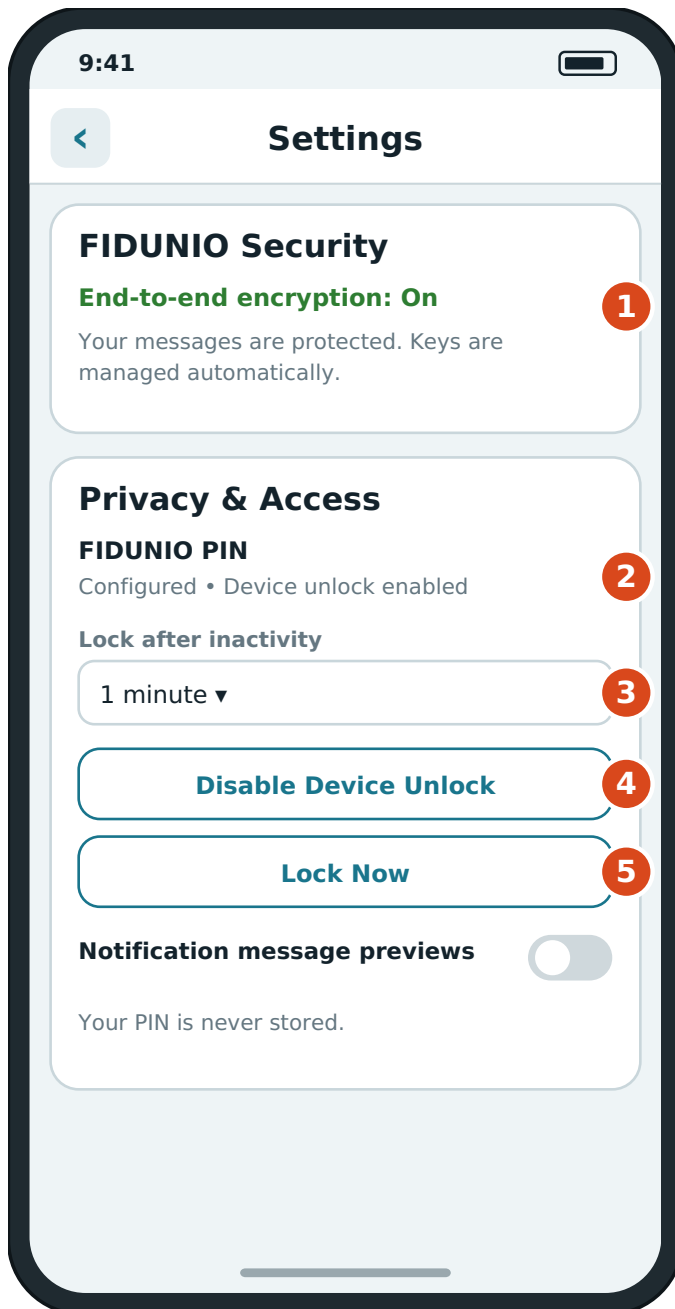


1 **Auto** follows your device's day/night setting; **Light** or **Dark** fixes it.

2 **A** standard, **A+** large, **A++** extra large — applies throughout FIDUNIO.

3 **Copy FIDUNIO ID** copies your account ID; **Sign Out** signs this device out.

Figure 16.2 — General: Appearance, Text Size, Account



1 End-to-end encryption: On means everything is set up. If it says **Setup required**, enter your password and PIN and tap **Unlock FIDUNIO Security**.

2 Your **FIDUNIO PIN** status and whether device unlock is on.

3 Lock after inactivity — choose how soon FIDUNIO locks itself.

4 Enable / Disable Device Unlock (Face ID, Touch ID or the device's own unlock).

5 Lock Now locks FIDUNIO immediately.

Figure 16.3 — FIDUNIO Security (Security section) and Privacy & Access (end of General)



- 1 **Large attachments on Wi-Fi only** (chapter 10).
- 2 Type your existing PIN before making or restoring a Recovery File.
- 3 **Create Recovery File** (chapter 19).
- 4 **Restore from Recovery File**.

Figure 16.4 — Data

17. Your profile and password

Go to **Settings** → **Profile**. You can change your **Display name**, **Email address**, **Telephone number** (optional) and **Profile picture URL**, then tap **Save Profile**. To change your email you must also type your **Current password**.

Changing your password

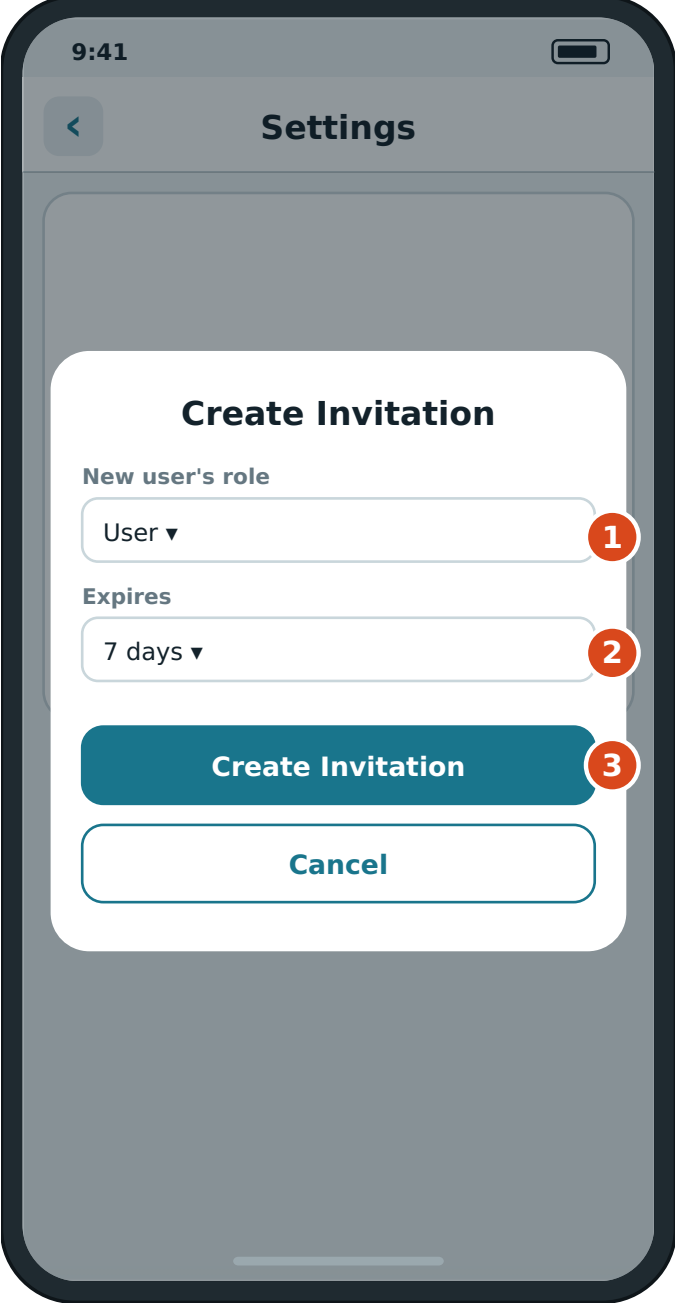
1. In the **Change Password** part, type your **Current password**.
2. Type the **New password** twice (at least 6 characters).
3. Type your six-digit **FIDUNIO PIN**.
4. Tap **Change Password**. The note **Password changed successfully** appears and the boxes are cleared.

Your PIN is needed because FIDUNIO re-protects your encryption key under the new password. Your messages, keys and PIN stay the same.

18. For administrators

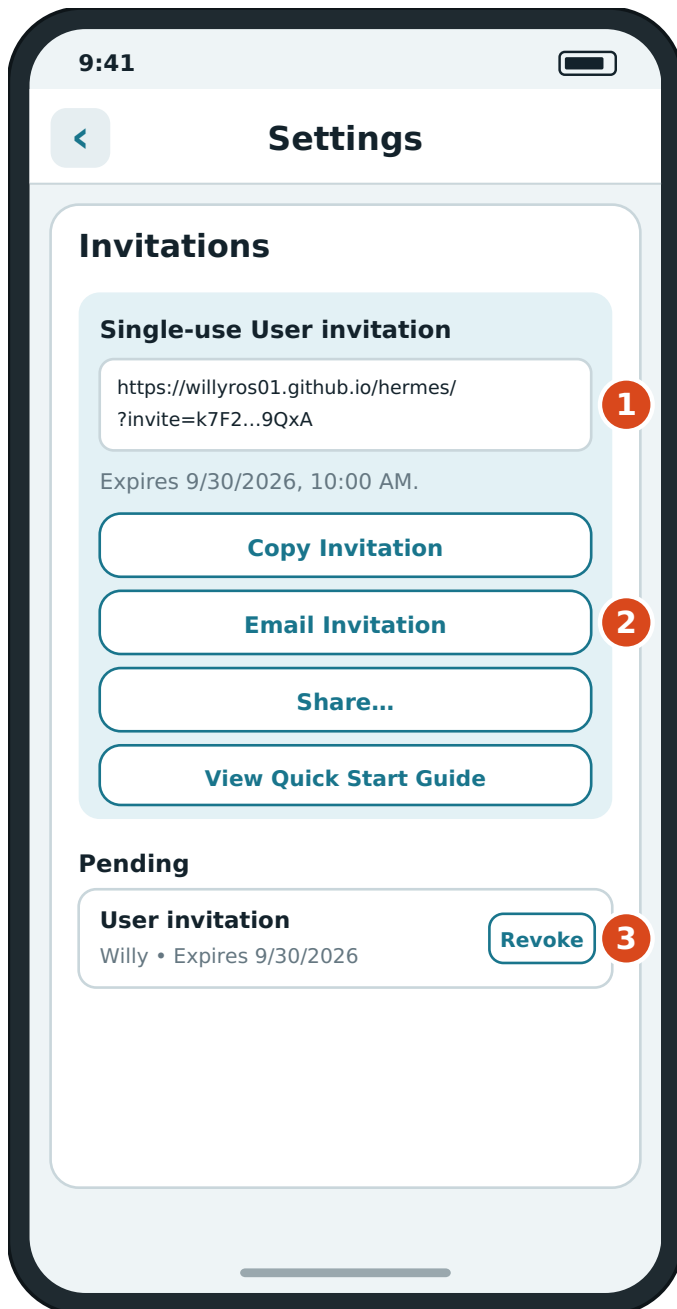
Owners and administrators see extra tools under **Settings** → **Invitations** and **Settings** → **User Administration**. Everyone else sees **Administrator access is required**.

Inviting someone

A screenshot of a mobile app's 'Settings' screen. A 'Create Invitation' dialog is centered on the screen. The dialog has a title 'Create Invitation' and two dropdown menus. The first dropdown is labeled 'New user's role' and has 'User' selected. The second dropdown is labeled 'Expires' and has '7 days' selected. Below the dropdowns are two buttons: 'Create Invitation' (in teal) and 'Cancel' (in white with a teal border). Three red circular callouts with numbers 1, 2, and 3 point to the 'User' dropdown, the '7 days' dropdown, and the 'Create Invitation' button respectively. The background shows the 'Settings' app interface with a back arrow and the title 'Settings'.

- 1 **New user's role** — User or Admin.
- 2 **Expires** — 1 day, 7 days or 30 days.
- 3 **Create Invitation**.

Figure 18.1 — Create Invitation



1 The single-use Join link.

2 **Copy Invitation**, **Email Invitation** or **Share...** send the full invitation letter, which includes the Quick Start Guide link.

3 Pending invitations with a **Revoke** button to cancel one.

Figure 18.2 — The finished invitation

Managing users

Tap **Manage Users & Access**. A table lists every user with role, status and expiry. Tap **•••** on a row for actions.

User Administration					Refresh
Users (4)					
User	Role	Status	Expires		
WR Willy Ros	OWNER	ACTIVE	No expiration	Current	
AT Ana Torres	ADMIN	ACTIVE	No expiration		1
JD Jun Dela Cruz	USER	SUSPENDED	No expiration	...	
MR Maria Reyes	USER	ACTIVE	12/31/2026	...	

Figure 18.3 — User Administration

Suspend

Deactivate

Expiration

Never

7 days

30 days

90 days

Recovery

Start Account Recovery

- 1 Suspend / Restore** — temporarily block or unblock the account.
- Deactivate** — switch the account off (asks to confirm).
- Expiration** — Never, 7, 30 or 90 days.
- Start Account Recovery** — see below.

Figure 18.4 — The ... action menu

You cannot change your own account or the Owner. Only the Owner can manage other administrators.

Authorizing account recovery

1. Choose **Start Account Recovery** for the user and confirm.
2. FIDUNIO creates a link that works **once** and **expires after 30 minutes**.
3. Send it with **Copy Recovery**, **Email Recovery** or **Share....** You can cancel it with **Revoke Authorization**.
4. The user opens the link, resets or signs in with their own password and enters their existing six-digit PIN.

An administrator never receives a user's password, PIN, encryption key, messages or attachments.

First-time setup

On a brand-new FIDUNIO system, Settings → Invitations shows **Claim FIDUNIO Owner**. The first account to claim it becomes the permanent Owner. Use this only on the primary administrator account.

19. Your Recovery File

A **Recovery File** is an encrypted backup of your FIDUNIO account data saved outside the browser, with the file ending **.fidunio**. It protects you if the Home Screen app is deleted or the browser's website data is cleared.

Making a Recovery File

1. Go to **Settings → Data**.
2. Type your existing six-digit PIN in the boxes.
3. Tap **Create Recovery File**. The file downloads.
4. Keep it somewhere you control (for example Files → iCloud Drive). Replace old files when you make a newer one.

Restoring

1. Sign in to the same account and go to **Settings → Data**.
2. Type your PIN, tap **Restore from Recovery File** and choose the .fidunio file.
3. Confirm. FIDUNIO checks the file and your current cloud permissions before replacing anything.

A Recovery File may contain messages that existed when it was made. Keep it private. Notification and Face ID / Touch ID settings are **not** restored — switch them on again afterwards.

20. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
A message stays Queued .	Check the connection. FIDUNIO retries automatically when you come back online or return to the app.
A message shows Failed .	Press and hold it, tap Delete Message , then send it again.
A photo says could not be opened .	Tap Try Again . If it keeps failing, ask the sender to resend.
The banner says Firestore connection problem .	Wait a moment, leave and re-open the chat, or close and reopen FIDUNIO.
This device uses a different FIDUNIO PIN.	Use the PIN you first set on this device.
This login is not enrolled in FIDUNIO.	The account was not created through an invitation. Ask an administrator for one.
You see Recover Secure Messaging after signing in.	Enter your existing six-digit PIN and tap Recover Messaging .
Notifications do not arrive.	Open FIDUNIO from the Home Screen icon, check Settings → Notifications says Enabled , and check notifications are allowed in the device's Settings app.
The app lost its data (website data cleared).	Sign in and enter your PIN to recover, or restore your Recovery File.
Text is too small.	Settings → General → Text Size → A++ .

21. Glossary

Word	Meaning
FIDUNIO PIN	Your six-digit code. It unlocks the app and protects your keys. Never stored.
End-to-end encryption (E2EE)	Only the people in the conversation can read it — not the server.
Installation	FIDUNIO on one particular browser or device.
Outbox	The encrypted waiting area on your device for messages not yet sent.
Archive	Hide a conversation on this device without deleting it.
Owner / Admin / User	The three roles. The Owner runs the system; admins manage users and invitations.
Recovery File	Your encrypted .fidunio backup.
Earlier history	Group messages from before a member joined, shared only if an admin grants it.
FIDUNIO ID	Your unique account identifier, shown in Settings → General → Account.